CONSULTATION

# Making the most of consultation

How to ask a consultation question colleagues can answer well, and what to do with the answers.

| AUDIENCE | FORMAT | VERSION | TIME |
|---|---|---|---|
| Psychologists · Psychiatrists | Guide | 1.0 · Nov 2026 | 10 minutes |

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|---|---|
| WHAT IT IS | A guide to preparing a consultation question and following through on what you learn. |
| USE IT WHEN | Before you post a question in Consult or bring a case to your group. |
| CUSTOMIZE FIRST | How much context the question needs and what you are hoping to gain. PA-05 is a fuller presentation template. |

## 1. Prepare your question

- [ ] Say what you hope to gain: a perspective, a resource, a referral or a check on your thinking.
- [ ] Give the context that matters: setting, age group, the question you are stuck on.
- [ ] Remove anything that could identify the client, alone or in combination: names, dates, employers, rare details, locations.

## 2. Choose who to ask

- [ ] One trusted colleague for a sensitive or narrow question.
- [ ] Your consultation group for a case you want to think through together.
- [ ] The wider network for a resource or a common clinical question.

## 3. Reflect and follow through

- [ ] Note the perspectives that fit your client and your approach, and the ones that do not.
- [ ] Record the consultation in the client record as your policies require.
- [ ] Thank colleagues and mark the question resolved when it is answered.

**BEFORE YOU USE IT**

Consultation does not transfer clinical responsibility: decisions about your client remain yours. Keep everything de-identified; if a detail could identify the client to someone who knows them, leave it out. This guide is educational and is not legal or clinical advice.

**NOTES**